

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an example.

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I now have that photo, and show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

It is very natural to assume that these questions must have determinate answers. There must be some fact of the matter about whether one of the people in the photo is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact of the matter about which one is you.

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be
in this picture, and must be a fact about which of the survivors you are.

Then we can ask a question about these facts:

**The survival
question:** What does it
take for for some
person at some other
time to be you?

To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be useful to think about a simple, uncontroversial example of survival.

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person who will wake up in your bed tomorrow morning.

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

This is the distinction between **numerical** and **qualitative** identity.

To say that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they are exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed tomorrow morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing different clothes.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow morning in that bed.



**materialist
survival**

A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the words "soul" and "survival" are written in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font, stacked vertically.

**soul
survival**



**psycho-
logical
survival**

Now that we have three answers to this question on the table, we can also see that various 'combination views' are possible. For example, you might think that you are a combination of a material thing and an immaterial soul, and that your survival requires that **both** that material thing and that soul survive, and be combined in the right way.

Our big question in this section of the class is different than the ones posed in our first two sections of the class. There we wondered whether God exists and whether free will exists.

Here we are taking for granted the fact that people occasionally survive from one moment to the next. That is, we are assuming that the answer to the question 'Do people ever survive?' is 'Yes.'

What we're asking is, 'What does it take for someone to survive from one moment to the next?'

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the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are aged 65 and over has increased from 10.5 million to 12.5 million, and the number of people aged 75 and over has increased from 4.5 million to 6.5 million (Office for National Statistics 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of older people in the community. The Department of Health (1999) has published a strategy for older people, which sets out the government's commitment to improve the lives of older people and to ensure that they are able to live independently and actively in the community.

The strategy is based on the following principles: older people should be able to live independently and actively in the community; older people should be able to participate in the life of the community; older people should be able to live in their own homes; and older people should be able to receive the care and support they need.

The strategy is a key document in the development of services for older people. It sets out the government's commitment to improve the lives of older people and to ensure that they are able to live independently and actively in the community. It also sets out the government's commitment to ensure that older people are able to participate in the life of the community.

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